

Final Exam

Course Title: **Inglés IX**
Term: **26-3**
Instructor: **Marron**
Exam Due Date: **18 August 2026**

General Instructions: This is a **take-home exam**. Please do your own work. Academic integrity is always your choice.

This final exam consists solely in writing a formal critique of Rulfo Anaya's novel, *Bless Me, Ultima*. The critique will be considered an academic paper and thus must follow specific outline and formatting requirements (see below). The critique should contain about 1200 words or about three (3) pages of single-spaced text. Print your paper double-sided if possible and make sure that your name, course number, and date appear in the upper right-hand corner of the title page.

Note that your critique will evaluate the development of one (1) major theme and will evaluate one (1) character or character set. A character set is a group of characters that can be evaluated as a single unit. For example, Tony's older brothers (Andrew, Eugene, and León) are considered a character set. Select your theme and character/character set from the lists below.

Your critique is officially **due in hard copy format on Tuesday, August 18, 2026 in Room 106 during our scheduled class time at UTECA**. You are welcome to turn in your critique anytime before the deadline. Graded documents will be available the week of August 24 at UTECA.

Themes

- Coming of Age
- Identity and Cultural Heritage
- Good vs. Evil
- Faith and Doubt
- Nature and the Supernatural
- Family and Community

Characters/Character Sets

- Antonio Márez
- Gabriel Márez
- María Luna Márez
- Andrew, Eugene, and León Márez
- Ultima
- Narciso
- Tenorio Trementina and his three daughters
- Cico, Florence, Samuel

Formatting and Outline Requirements for the Final Exam

Overall document formatting requirements for the final exam are the same as for homework assignments, That is, you must use

- 12 pt Times New Roman font,
- 0.5 in margins, and
- single-spaced text.

The specific outline requirements for the final exam are given below along with the minimum content.

Your Name
IT 0939 (Marron)
Date

Final Exam English IX A Critique of Rudolfo Anaya's, *Bless Me, Ultima*

Introduction

What is *Bless Me, Ultima*? Why is it important?
Who is Rudolfo Anaya? Why is he famous? When did he publish the book
Provide a very brief overview of the book
Briefly explain what your critique will accomplish

Major Theme Development

Theme 1

Definition of the theme
Describe how the theme is developed citing examples from the book
Evaluate the author's ability to develop the theme

Character Development

Character/Character Set 1

Description of the character
Describe how the character is developed citing examples from the book
Evaluate the author's ability to develop the character

Major Story Arc

Briefly define and/or diagram the major story arc using the following standard chronological construction:

- **Exposition:** Introduces the characters, setting, and initial situation.
- **Rising Action:** Builds tension and conflict, leading towards the climax.
- **Climax:** The turning point of the story, often the most intense moment of conflict.

- **Falling Action:** The events following the climax, where the conflict begins to resolve.
- **Resolution:** The conclusion of the story, where loose ends are tied up and the conflict is resolved

Anaya's Writing Style

Evaluate Rudolfo Anaya's writing style with regards to

- Ease of reading
- Flow of text
- Realistic dialog
- Excess wordiness
- Emotive potential
- Logical connectivity

Conclusions

- Summarize Major Theme Development section
- Summarize Character Development section
- Summarize Story Arcs section
- Summarize Writing Style section
- State your personal opinion of the novel